

Asian wild buffalo

Bubalus arnee

- ↔ 8–10 ft (2.4–3 m)
- 📍 S. Asia
- ⊗ Endangered

The big, powerful Asian wild buffalo is the ancestor of the domestic water buffalo, but while the latter is widespread and common, its wild counterpart is now very rare. It is adapted for eating lush marsh vegetation, with broad, splayed feet that help stop it from sinking into the mud. Females live in herds with their young, while young males form bachelor groups. Older males are



solitary; they compete for females by sparring with their horns, which can span more than 79 in (200 cm).

Wisent

Bison bonasus

- ↔ 7–11 ft (2.1–3.4 m)
- 📍 E. Europe
- ⊗ Vulnerable

The wisent is the European bison, a very close relative of the similar American bison. Driven to extinction in the wild by the 1920s, it was reintroduced to the Bialoweza forest in eastern Europe using animals bred from bison held captive in zoos. Small wild populations have also been established elsewhere. It feeds on grasses and the leaves of forest trees and shrubs, and lives in small herds.

Yak

Bos mutus

- ↔ Up to 11 ft (3.4 m)
- 📍 C. Asia
- ⊗ Vulnerable

The larger, wild form of the domestic yak is now extremely rare and restricted to the desolate, bitterly cold steppe grasslands of the Tibetan plateau and part of neighboring Kashmir. It is one of the wild cattle, but specialized for its hostile habitat with a coat of long, shaggy, black or dark brown hair concealing a dense, soft undercoat. It grazes on plants and eats snow when it cannot find water.

Nilgai

Boselaphus tragocamelus

- ↔ 6–7 ft (1.8–2.1 m)
- 📍 S. Asia
- ⊗ Common

Also known as the bluebuck or blue bull, this large antelope has an oxlike appearance, but with longer legs and a much smaller head. Females are tawny with a white throat and a dark mane; males are larger and bluish gray, with a pair of short horns. Nilgai live in open woods, where they feed on leaves, fruit, and grasses while staying sharply alert for powerful predators, such as tigers.

Bush duiker

Sylvicapra grimmia

- ↔ 2–4 ft (0.7–1.2 m)
- 📍 W., C., E., and Southern Africa
- ⊗ Common

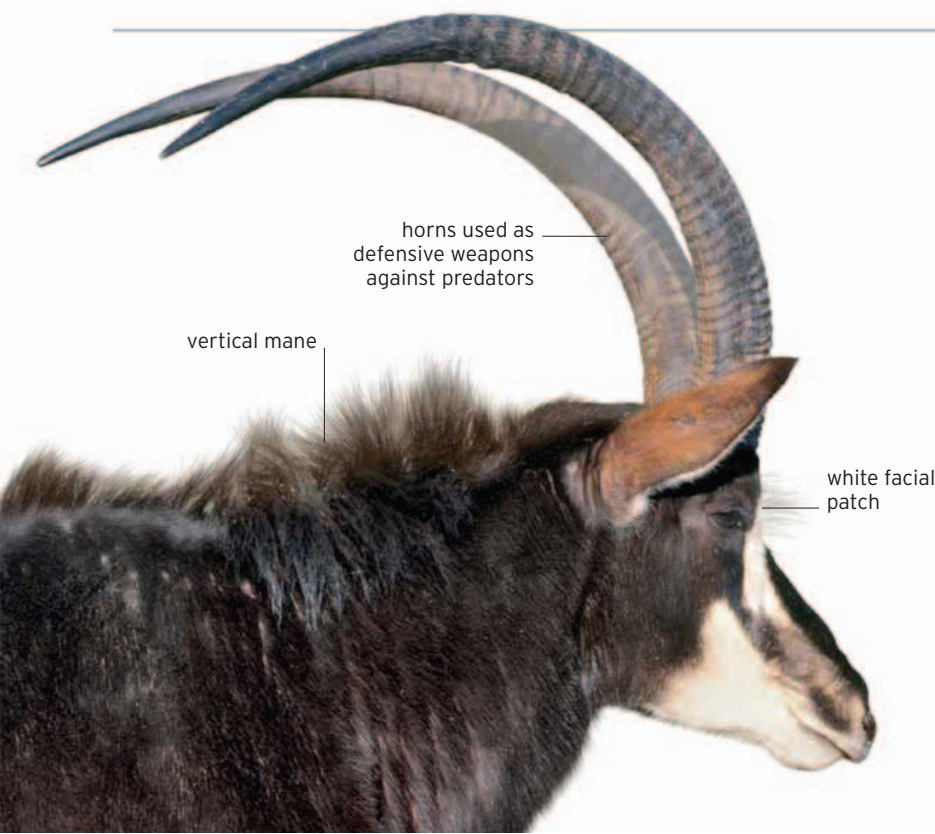
The common duiker is a small antelope with a dark stripe down its nose and short, sharp horns. It has a wide range across Africa. Its diet ranges from various plant foods to occasional small animals. The duiker can survive without water for long periods, obtaining all the moisture it needs from its food. The males use their horns to defend territories against rivals; females use them to defend their young.

Common waterbuck

Kobus ellipsiprymnus

- ↔ 4–8 ft (1.3–2.4 m)
- 📍 W., C., and E. Africa
- ⊗ Common

The waterbuck is adapted for wet habitats. It has skin glands that secrete a musky-smelling oil, which waterproofs its long, coarse fur. When threatened, it leaps into the nearest water body, where it either swims to safety or submerges except for its nose. It feeds on grass and lives in herds of 6–20 animals. Males use their long, ridged and ringed horns to fight for dominance, sometimes inflicting deadly wounds.



Southern sable antelope

Hippotragus niger

- ↔ 6–9 ft (1.8–2.7 m)
- 📍 E. to SE. Africa
- ⊗ Common

A mature male southern sable antelope is black all over, except for its cheeks, chin, and underparts; females are smaller and browner, but both sexes have heavily ringed horns that curve up and back from the forehead. In the rainy season, males compete for territories, and the victors dominate small herds of females. During the dry season, they switch from grazing to browsing, sometimes gathering in larger, mixed-sex herds of 100 or more.

Gemsbok

Oryx gazella

- ↔ 5–8 ft (1.5–2.4 m)
- 📍 SW. Africa
- ⊗ Locally common

The big, long-horned gemsbok roams in nomadic herds across the deserts of southwest Africa, searching for the grass, leaves, and fruit that appear after sporadic rainstorms. It relies on fruit such as wild melons and cucumbers to supply much of its water, although it is well adapted to avoid moisture loss, not sweating until its body temperature reaches 113°F (45°C). Like many desert species, gemsbok breed opportunistically, and year-round when food is available.